

THE MODERN-DAY PROFESSIONAL

An institutional capability lab for employability, innovation confidence and industry readiness

⚡ **VALUE PROMISE:** Graduate readiness • Applied problem-solving • Employer connection



AUDIENCE

Students & early-career talent

DURATION

1 day | 9:30-17:00

FORMAT

Interactive bootcamp

CUSTOM PROGRAM

Discuss with us

■ Why this matters now

FOR ACADEMIC LEADERS

Strengthen graduate employability and institutional industry relevance through applied problem-finding, storytelling and innovation.

WHY STUDENTS NEED IT

Students develop employer-valued problem-finding, storytelling, AI judgement and collaboration skills beyond grades and technical knowledge.

WHY ACADEMICIANS NEED IT

Academics connect curriculum and mentoring to employability, interdisciplinary projects and stronger institutional engagement with industry.

■ What we will explore

- Build the capability portfolio of an adaptable, modern professional.
- Strengthen problem-finding, communication, digital fluency and ethical judgement.
- Translate academic work into language valued by employers and partners.

■ What participants gain

- **Find opportunity:** recognise novel problems with academic and industry relevance.
- **Show contribution:** frame work around outcomes rather than publication count alone.
- **Build an IP mindset:** recognise potentially novel, non-obvious solution elements.
- **Win collaboration:** communicate a credible value case to employers and funders.

INSTITUTIONAL RETURN

Stronger employability evidence, industry-ready student projects and more purposeful placement engagement.

Build capability beyond technical competence

A structured day for problem-finding, professional storytelling, AI judgement, inventive thinking and opportunity creation.

■ One-day learning journey

09:30-10:15	The changing professional	Explore AI, ambiguity and the new combination of human and digital strengths.
10:15-11:15	Find problems worth solving	Connect trends, stakeholder pain points and personal capability.
11:30-12:45	Storytelling that travels	Present evidence, contribution and impact for interviews and influence.
13:45-15:00	Inventive problem-solving	Use TRIZ patterns, contradictions and practical idea selection.
15:15-16:15	Reverse brainstorming and IP awareness	Uncover risks and identify defensible solution elements.
16:15-17:00	Opportunity pitch	Build relationship capital and a 60-day collaboration and growth sprint.

■ Who should attend

- Final-year undergraduate and postgraduate students
- Doctoral scholars, research associates and early-career faculty
- Placement and student-development cohorts

■ Methods & tools

- Opportunity and career mapping
- Storytelling with evidence of impact
- Collaboration, feedback and influence
- Responsible AI and digital judgement
- TRIZ, reverse brainstorming and IP
- Industry engagement and pitching

■ Takeaway toolkit

- A personal T-shaped capability and opportunity map
- An employer-ready professional story supported by evidence
- An inventive solution developed through TRIZ and reverse brainstorming
- A practical 60-day learning, networking and collaboration sprint

■ Custom program

Custom programs can be discussed

The scope can be shaped around the cohort, institutional priorities and desired outcomes. Workbook, capability map, pitch template and participation certificate can be included.

Three pillars of innovation

An idea becomes strategically interesting when it is **unique**, **hard to do** and **value adding** at the same time. The programs build student capability across all three.

01 UNIQUENESS

Meaningfully different

Students learn to ask whether the problem, insight or solution is genuinely different from what already exists - not merely a new implementation of a familiar idea.

SKILLS BUILT

Problem discovery, reframing, prior-art awareness, assumption breaking, divergent thinking and TRIZ.

02 HARD TO DO

Technically defensible

Innovation needs technical or execution depth. Students learn to work with constraints, contradictions, evidence and experiments so the idea is more than a superficial concept. **SKILLS**

BUILT

Systems thinking, technical trade-offs, experimentation, prototyping, non-obviousness and execution discipline.

03 VALUE ADDING

Creates real value

A clever idea is not automatically valuable. Students learn to connect innovation to a real user, institution, industry or societal need and define the change it should create. **SKILLS**

BUILT

Stakeholder insight, outcome framing, evidence, adoption thinking, value articulation and storytelling.

■ Why all three have to come together

Unique + valuable, but easy to copy

Interesting, but difficult to defend or sustain.

Unique + hard, but low value

Technically impressive, but unlikely to matter outside the project.

Hard + valuable, but not unique

Useful engineering, but limited differentiation or innovation claim.

Unique + hard + value adding

A stronger foundation for defensible innovation and meaningful impact.

■ How I help students build the three muscles

DISCOVER

Find tensions, unmet needs and consequential problems.

CHALLENGE

Question assumptions and seek a genuinely different angle.

BUILD

Work through constraints, contradictions and technical depth.

VALIDATE

Test evidence, stakeholder value, utility and feasibility.

COMMUNICATE

Turn the work into a research, patent or industry story.

THE CORE HABIT

Do not ask only, "Can we build it?" Ask: "Is it different? Is it difficult enough to be defensible? Does it create enough value to matter?"

What the three pillars are designed to enable

The objective is not idea generation for its own sake. Students learn to convert differentiated, substantive and useful ideas into stronger research, invention and industry-facing evidence.

■ Outcome 01 - Impactful research

UNIQUENESS

A consequential question, clearer research gap and a contribution that is meaningfully different.

HARD TO DO

Technical depth, rigorous methods, experiments, difficult trade-offs and credible evidence.

VALUE ADDING

A problem that matters to a field, stakeholder, industry, society or future system.

STUDENT-OWNED EVIDENCE

Problem landscape • novelty map • research question • experiment plan • contribution statement • publication pathway.

■ Outcome 02 - Patents and defensible IP

UNIQUENESS

Prior-art awareness and a clearly differentiated mechanism, method or system element.

HARD TO DO

Non-obvious technical substance, constraints and implementation depth that make the idea defensible.

VALUE ADDING

Utility, adoption potential and a reason the invention should exist beyond novelty alone.

STUDENT-OWNED EVIDENCE

Invention canvas • prior-art search terms • novelty hypothesis • non-obviousness rationale • prototype or evidence plan.

■ Outcome 03 - Industry-ready innovators

UNIQUENESS

Spot opportunities others miss and frame a differentiated response rather than repeating obvious solutions.

HARD TO DO

Move from idea to execution: handle constraints, collaborate, experiment, learn and improve.

VALUE ADDING

Connect technical work to business, user and societal outcomes and explain why it matters.

STUDENT-OWNED EVIDENCE

Problem brief • prototype or concept • decision rationale • outcome story • pitch • 30/60-day action plan.

WHAT ACADEMIC LEADERS CAN REVIEW AFTER A COHORT

Problem portfolio • research directions • possible IP candidates • experiment plans • industry-facing pitches • participant capability evidence • recommended next steps.

The program builds capability and stronger pathways. Publication, patent and hiring outcomes are not guaranteed and depend on the quality of subsequent work, evidence, review and execution.